STEP-BY-STEP WORKSHOP GUIDE

Build An Email Capture Lead Magnet

Go from zero to a live landing page — collecting real emails — using AI coding agents. Total cost: $20 (one-time).

No coding experience required.

What's Inside

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What you'll need:

- A computer (Mac, Windows, or Linux)
- An internet connection
- A Claude Code subscription ($20/month — you can cancel after one month)
- An idea for something you want to offer (guide, checklist, mini-course, etc.)

1 Define Your Offer

Before you touch any tools, get clear on what you're building. A good landing page starts with a clear offer — not with code.

Answer these eight questions. Write your answers down — you'll use them directly in your prompts later.

The Intake Questions

1. **Who is this for?** — Describe your target audience in plain language.
2. **What is the offer?** — What are you giving them? (PDF, guide, checklist, video, template...)
3. **What result does it create?** — What will they be able to do after using it?
4. **What is the primary CTA?** — What action do you want them to take? (Join the list, get the guide, book a call...)
5. **Why should they trust you?** — What's your credibility? (Experience, results, background...)
6. **What tone should the page have?** — Pick 3 adjectives. (e.g. friendly, direct, professional)
7. **What visual style?** — Keep it simple. (e.g. clean, minimal, warm colours)
8. **What happens after signup?** — Do they get an email? A download? A redirect?

Write Your Positioning Sentence

Once you've answered those, reduce it to one line:

> *I help **[audience]** get **[result]** through **[offer]**.*

Example: *I help solo founders get their first landing page live through a free workshop pack and AI prompts.*

> **Why this matters:** If you skip this step, the AI will build a generic page. The clearer your answers, the better the result. Spend 15 minutes here — it saves hours later.

2 Set Up Your Tools

You need three things installed before you start building. All free or low-cost.

2.1 — Install VS Code

VS Code is a free code editor. It's where you'll work with your files and talk to Claude Code.

a. Go to **code.visualstudio.com** and download the version for your operating system (Mac, Windows, or Linux).

b. Run the installer and follow the prompts. Accept the defaults — they're fine.

c. Open VS Code. You should see a welcome screen. That means it's working.

2.2 — Get a Claude Code Subscription

Claude Code is the AI coding agent that will build your site. It costs **$20/month** — and you can cancel after one month if you only need it for this project.

a. Go to **claude.ai** and sign up for an account if you don't have one.

b. Subscribe to the **Pro plan** ($20/month). This gives you access to Claude Code.

2.3 — Install the Claude Code Extension

a. Open VS Code.

b. Click the **Extensions** icon in the left sidebar (it looks like four small squares).

c. Search for **"Claude Code"** in the search bar.

d. Click **Install** on the official Claude Code extension by Anthropic.

e. Once installed, you'll see a Claude Code icon in your sidebar. Click it and sign in with your Claude account.

> **Tip:** If the extension asks you to install Node.js, follow its instructions. Node.js is a free tool that Claude Code needs to run. Go to **nodejs.org** and download the LTS (Long Term Support) version.

3 Create a GitHub Account

GitHub is where your code lives online. You need it for two reasons:

1. **To pull down the starter project** that has the prompts and structure ready for you.
2. **To deploy your finished site** — Netlify (the free hosting service) connects directly to GitHub.

3.1 — Sign Up

a Go to **github.com** and click **Sign up**.

b Enter your email, create a password, and choose a username. The free plan is all you need.

c Verify your email address when GitHub sends you a confirmation.

3.2 — What Is Git?

Git is a tool that tracks changes to your files — like a save-point system. GitHub is the online service that stores your Git projects. Here's all you need to know for now:

- **Repository (repo)** — A project folder that Git is tracking.
- **Clone** — Downloading a copy of a repo to your computer.
- **Commit** — Saving a snapshot of your changes.
- **Push** — Uploading your commits to GitHub.

Don't worry about memorising this. Claude Code will handle the Git commands for you — you just need to understand the words.

3.3 — Install Git (If Not Already Installed)

Most Macs come with Git pre-installed. To check:

```
git --version
```

If you see a version number, you're good. If not:

- **Mac:** Open Terminal and type `git`. macOS will prompt you to install developer tools. Click Install.
- **Windows:** Download Git from **git-scm.com**. Run the installer with default settings.

4 Start Your Project

Now you'll pull down the starter project and open it in VS Code. This starter has the prompts, structure, and Claude Code instructions already set up for you.

4.1 — Fork the Starter Repo

a. Go to the starter repo on GitHub: **github.com/your-username/email-capture-demo**

   (The exact URL will be shared with you during the workshop or in your welcome email.)

b. Click the **Fork** button in the top right. This creates your own copy of the project under your GitHub account.

4.2 — Clone It to Your Computer

a. On your forked repo page, click the green **Code** button and copy the HTTPS URL.

b. Open VS Code. Open the terminal by pressing `Ctrl + ` ` (backtick) on Windows, or `Cmd + ` ` on Mac.

c. Navigate to where you want to keep the project (e.g. your Desktop):

```
cd ~/Desktop
```

d. Clone the repo:

```
git clone https://github.com/YOUR-USERNAME/email-capture-demo.git
```

   Replace `YOUR-USERNAME` with your actual GitHub username.

e. Open the folder in VS Code:

```
cd email-capture-demo
```

Then in VS Code, go to **File → Open Folder** and select the `email-capture-demo` folder.

4.3 — Check What's Inside

You should see these files in the sidebar:

- `CLAUDE.md` — Instructions that Claude Code reads automatically. Don't edit this.
- `PROMPTS.md` — The prompts and intake questions you'll use.
- `README.md` — Project overview.

No site files yet — that's intentional. You're about to build them.

5 Build Your Landing Page with Claude Code

This is where it gets fun. You'll tell Claude Code about your offer, and it will generate your entire landing page.

5.1 — Open Claude Code

Click the Claude Code icon in the VS Code sidebar. The chat panel will open. This is where you type your prompts.

5.2 — Use the First Build Prompt

Copy this prompt and fill in the blanks with your answers from Section 1:

> PROMPT — FIRST BUILD
>
> Build a responsive one-page landing site for this offer.
>
> **Audience:** [your audience]
> **Offer:** [your offer]
> **Outcome:** [the result they get]
> **Primary CTA:** [join list / get guide / join waitlist / book call]
> **Tone:** [3 adjectives]

> **Style:** [visual direction]
> **Proof:** [your bio / results / credibility]
> **Sections:** hero, problem, offer, benefits, about, FAQ, signup, footer
> **Technical constraints:** plain HTML/CSS/JS, mobile-first, simple to deploy
> **Important:** leave a clear placeholder for a Kit embedded form
> **Output:** ready-to-deploy files

Paste this into Claude Code and hit Enter. It will generate `index.html`, `styles.css`, and possibly a `script.js` file.

5.3 — Preview Your Page

To see what it looks like:

1. Find `index.html` in your VS Code sidebar.
2. Right-click it and select **Open with Live Server** (if you have the Live Server extension) — or simply double-click the file to open it in your browser.

> **Don't have Live Server?** Install it from VS Code Extensions — search for "Live Server" by Ritwick Dey. It lets you preview your page in the browser with auto-refresh.

5.4 — Refine It

Your first version won't be perfect. Use these follow-up prompts to improve it:

> PROMPT — TIGHTEN COPY
>
> Tighten the copy, make the CTA clearer, and simplify the layout.

> PROMPT — ADD CREDIBILITY
>
> Improve the page so it feels more credible and specific without adding unnecessary sections.

> PROMPT — POLISH DESIGN

> Make the design feel more polished while keeping the code simple and the layout easy to scan on mobile.

Run each prompt one at a time. Preview the result after each change. Keep what works, adjust what doesn't.

5.5 — Save Your Progress with Git

After each major change, save a snapshot. You can ask Claude Code to do this for you:

> PROMPT — COMMIT
>
> Please commit the current changes with a short descriptive message.

Or do it yourself in the terminal:

```
git add .
git commit -m "Generate initial landing page"
```

Do this after each round of changes so you never lose progress.

6 Set Up Email Collection with Kit

Kit (formerly ConvertKit) is an email marketing tool with a free plan. You'll use it to collect email addresses from your landing page.

6.1 — Create a Kit Account

a. Go to **kit.com** and sign up for a free account.

b. Complete the onboarding steps. Pick "Creator" when it asks what you do — it doesn't really matter.

6.2 — Create a Form

a. In Kit, go to **Grow → Landing Pages & Forms**.

b. Click **Create New** → choose **Form**.

c Pick any template — it doesn't matter because we won't use the visual form. We only need the **Form ID**.

d Save the form. Note the **Form ID** — you can find it in the URL when editing the form. It looks like: `kit.com/forms/designers/1234567/edit`

6.3 — Get Your API Key

> **Important:** This is the step that trips most people up. We use the Kit API directly (not the embed code) because it gives us full control over the form design and the success message.

a In Kit, go to **Settings → Developer** (or navigate to **app.kit.com/account/edit#api_key**).

b You'll see your **API Key** (also called "Public API Key"). Copy it.

You now have two things you need:

- **Form ID** — the number from the URL when editing your form
- **API Key** — the key from Settings → Developer

6.4 — Integrate with Claude Code

Now tell Claude Code to wire it up. Use this prompt:

> PROMPT — KIT INTEGRATION
>
> Replace the signup form placeholder with a real Kit email signup. Use the Kit API directly (not embed code). Here are my details:
>
> **Form ID:** [your form ID]
> **API Key:** [your API key]
>
> The form should:
>
> - POST to `https://api.convertkit.com/v3/forms/[FORM_ID]/subscribe`
> - Send the email and api_key as JSON

- Show a thank-you message on success
- Handle CORS gracefully (the subscription may succeed even if the browser reports an error)

Why the API method? Kit's embed forms inject their own styling and can be hard to make look right. The API method lets your form match your page perfectly. The one catch: CORS (a browser security feature) may block the response — but the subscription still goes through. That's why we show the thank-you message in both the success and error cases.

6.5 — Test It

1. Open your page in the browser.
2. Enter a test email address and submit.
3. Check Kit → **Subscribers** to confirm the email appeared.
4. If it did, the integration is working — even if the browser console shows a CORS warning.

7 Deploy Your Site

Time to put your page on the internet. We'll use **Netlify** — it's free and connects directly to your GitHub repo.

7.1 — Push to GitHub

First, make sure all your changes are committed and pushed:

> PROMPT — PUSH TO GITHUB
>
> Please commit any uncommitted changes and push everything to GitHub.

Or do it manually:

```
git add .
git commit -m "Final version ready for deploy"
git push origin main
```

> **First time pushing?** Git may ask you to authenticate. It will open a browser window where you log in to GitHub. Follow the prompts — this only happens once.

7.2 — Connect Netlify

a. Go to **netlify.com** and sign up with your **GitHub account**.

b. Click **Add new site → Import an existing project**.

c. Select **GitHub** as the source and authorize Netlify to access your repos.

d. Find and select your **email-capture-demo** repo.

e. Leave the build settings as-is (no build command needed for static files). Click **Deploy site**.

f. In about 30 seconds, Netlify will give you a live URL like `random-name-12345.netlify.app`.

7.3 — Custom Domain (Optional)

If you have your own domain, you can connect it in Netlify under **Domain settings**. But the free `.netlify.app` URL works perfectly for testing and early launches.

7.4 — Pre-Launch Checklist

- ☐ CTA is clear and visible
- ☐ Signup form works (test with a real email)
- ☐ Mobile layout looks good (check on your phone)
- ☐ Thank-you message shows after signup
- ☐ Subscriber appears in Kit
- ☐ All links and buttons work

8 Bonus: Debug Kit with Claude Code

Here's something most people don't realise: Claude Code isn't just for building websites. If a service has an API, Claude Code can talk to it. Kit has a full API — which means you can use Claude Code to check your subscribers, test automations, and debug problems without clicking through Kit's dashboard.

8.1 — Find Your API Secret

You already have your public API Key from Section 6. Now you need the **API Secret** — this is the private key that gives full read/write access to your Kit account.

a In Kit, go to **Settings → Developer**.

b Below the API Key, you'll see **API Secret**. Copy it.

> **Keep this secret.** Your API Key (public) is safe to put in your website code — it can only subscribe people. Your API Secret can read subscriber data, send emails, and manage your account. Never commit it to code or share it publicly. Using it in a Claude Code conversation is fine — that stays local on your machine.

8.2 — Ask Claude Code to Check Your Setup

With your API Secret, you can ask Claude Code to inspect your Kit account directly. Try these prompts:

> PROMPT — LIST FORMS
>
> Use the Kit API to list all my forms. My API Key is [your API key].

> PROMPT — CHECK SUBSCRIBERS
>
> Use the Kit API to show me the subscribers on my form [form ID]. My API Secret is [your API secret].

> PROMPT — CHECK SEQUENCES
>
> Use the Kit API to list my sequences and show how many subscribers are in each one. My API Secret is [your API secret].

8.3 — Test an Automation

If your automation isn't firing, you can ask Claude Code to manually add a subscriber to a sequence to check whether the email sends:

> PROMPT — TEST SEQUENCE
>
> Use the Kit API to subscribe [test email] to my sequence [sequence ID]. My API Secret is [your API secret].

If the email arrives, your sequence works — the problem is how the automation connects to your form. If it doesn't arrive, the issue is in the sequence or email itself.

8.4 — The Bigger Idea

This pattern works with any service that has an API — not just Kit. Stripe, Notion, GitHub, Slack, Mailchimp, Airtable — if it has an API, you can ask Claude Code to interact with it for you.

You don't need to learn the API documentation. You just describe what you want in plain English, hand over the credentials, and Claude Code figures out the right API calls. That's the real power of an AI coding agent: it's a universal interface to any tool with an API.

9 Prompt Reference

All the prompts from this guide in one place. Copy and customise as needed.

First Build Prompt

> Build a responsive one-page landing site for this offer.
>
> Audience: [audience]
> Offer: [offer]
> Outcome: [result]
> Primary CTA: [join list / get guide / join waitlist / book call]
> Tone: [3 adjectives]
> Style: [visual direction]
> Proof: [bio / results / credibility]
> Sections: hero, problem, offer, benefits, about, FAQ, signup, footer
> Technical constraints: plain HTML/CSS/JS, mobile-first, simple to deploy

> Important: leave a clear placeholder for a Kit embedded form
> Output: ready-to-deploy files

Refinement Prompts

> Tighten the copy, make the CTA clearer, and simplify the layout.

> Improve the page so it feels more credible and specific without adding unnecessary sections.

> Make the design feel more polished while keeping the code simple and the layout easy to scan on mobile.

Kit Integration Prompt

> Replace the signup form placeholder with a real Kit email signup. Use the Kit API directly (not embed code). Here are my details:
>
> Form ID: [your form ID]
> API Key: [your API key]
>
> The form should POST to https://api.convertkit.com/v3/forms/[FORM_ID]/subscribe with the email and api_key as JSON. Show a thank-you message on success. Handle CORS gracefully — show the thank-you in both success and error cases.

Kit Debugging Prompts

> Use the Kit API to list all my forms. My API Key is [your API key].

> Use the Kit API to show me the subscribers on my form [form ID]. My API Secret is [your API secret].

> Use the Kit API to subscribe [test email] to my sequence [sequence ID]. My API Secret is [your API secret].

Git / Commit Prompt

> Please commit the current changes with a short descriptive message.

Deploy Prompt

> Please commit any uncommitted changes and push everything to GitHub.

You Did It

If you've followed every step, you now have:

- ☐ A clear, defined offer
- ☐ A live landing page you built with AI
- ☐ A real email signup that collects subscribers

Total cost: **$20** for one month of Claude Code. Everything else is free.

The best part? You can repeat this process for any new offer, project, or idea. The prompts and workflow are yours to keep.